



National Accreditation Board for Testing and Calibration Laboratories (NABL)

Pre-Assessment Guidelines and Forms (based on ISO 20387: 2018)

ISSUE NO.: 01
ISSUE DATE: 21-Oct-2025

AMENDMENT NO.: --
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AMENDMENT SHEET

Sl.	Amendment No.	Page No.	Clause No.	Date of Amendment	Amendment	Reasons	Signature of QA Team	Signature of Competent Authority
1.								
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GUIDE TO USE PRE-ASSESSMENT FORMS & CHECKLIST

1. INTRODUCTION

The Lead Assessor shall have the overall responsibility of conducting the pre-assessment of the biobank. During initial assessment lead assessor will be accompanied by team of technical assessors commensurate with the scope of accreditation.

This document contains pre-assessment forms and checklist, which shall be used to report the pre-assessment findings. The document shall guide the lead assessor in completing various forms & checklists and compiling the report.

2. PRE-ASSESSMENT

Once the document review process is completed, a pre-assessment of the biobank is conducted (if opted by the biobank or if NABL decides to conduct the same based on the outcome of document review as pre-assessment is optional) by lead assessor appointed by NABL. The date for pre-assessment finalized in consultation with the biobank and the lead assessor.

While the lead assessor proceeds to the biobank for pre-assessment, he/she should be in possession of the biobank's applications form, management system document, corrective action report on the document review (if any) and any other information supplied by NABL secretariat.

The lead assessor, during pre-assessment shall:

- i. Check the overall implementation of the management system as per the documented management system document
- ii. Study the scope of accreditation so that the time frame, number of assessors required in various category for the assessment can be determined. The Lead Assessor shall also assess the risks associated with the category and personnel, if any which need to be taken into consideration while planning, scheduling and/or conducting assessment.
- iii. Check whether the biobank has conducted a comprehensive internal audit in accordance with ISO 20387: 2018.
- iv. Assess the degree of preparedness of the biobank for the initial assessment in terms of compliance to NPF 1.
- v. Explain to the biobank regarding the methodology to be adopted for assessment and the obligations of the biobank.
- vi. Submit a report to NABL.

3. COMPILATION OF PREASSESSMENT FORMS & CHECKLIST

The Lead Assessor must review the Biobank's management system documents to verify compliance with the requirements of ISO 20387: 2018. The Lead Assessor should complete the Checklist NPF(B) 1 by recording his observation – 'Yes' or 'No' (by marking a ☐ in the appropriate box), related to the requirements of respective clause number of the checklist and offering along with brief comments. If the Lead Assessor has a doubt in other area(s), even though not listed in the checklist, the lead assessor is free to assess or go into details and annex his/her findings, to the report.

All Non-Conformity(ies) must be identified and to be reported in NPF(B) 2. Additional sheets may be added, if required. The Lead Assessor should finally summarise the conduct of Pre-Assessment and record the recommendations in NPF 3. The Lead Assessor must carefully fill the forms and check list and sign all pages of the Pre-Assessment Report (for cross-frontier CABs). Lead assessor should also obtain signature of the authorised person of the biobank on NPF (B) 2 & 3. The report should be compiled in the order NPF(B) 3, 2, 1 & Form 74 and any other additional pages or annexure thereafter.

The Lead Assessor shall submit the Pre-Assessment Report to NABL Secretariat within 03 days of completion of Pre-Assessment.

National Accreditation Board for Testing and Calibration Laboratories				
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PRE-ASSESSMENT CHECKLIST

Biobank:		Date of Assessment:	
Sl.	Requirement	Observation (Mark ✓ in the appropriate box)	
		Yes	No
1.	Review of Application Form (NABL 227)		
	a) correctness of contents		
	b) scope of accreditation		
	Remarks:		
2.	Quality Management System Requirements		
	Availability of objectives and policies in the biobank		
	Availability of management system documents		
	Availability of procedures and records as per the standard requirements.		
	Availability of copies of regulations, standards and other normative reference documents.		
	Remarks:		
3.	Management System Documentation		
	Document review - cross-reference to procedures and other documents		
	Availability of all required cross-referenced procedures (list to be enclosed) (wherever applicable)		
	Availability of NABL documents (list to be enclosed)		
	Remarks:		
	Personnel		
	a) Availability of competence requirements of biobank personnel		
	b) Training program on ISO 20387: 2018 for the biobank personnel		
	c) Plan/ Schedule for imparting training to biobank personnel for the current year		
	d) Availability of competent personnel responsible for implementation, maintenance and improvement of management system of the biobank and authorize the report		
	Remarks:		
4.	Facilities/dedicated areas and Environmental conditions		
	a) Biobank have suitable facilities/dedicated area and their environmental conditions for biobanking		
	b) Whether biobank is maintaining the environmental conditions for biobank activities (sample audit)		
	c) Whether biobank has a procedure and records for disposal of sample as per current Biomedical Waste Management Guidelines and IBSC approval (Institutional Biosafety Committee) for biosafety and biosecurity.		
	Remarks:		
5.	Equipment		
	a) Availability of equipment commensurate with the scope applied for performance of biobanking		
	b) Availability of processes for controlled implementation, safe handling, transport, storage and planned maintenance of all the equipment's		
	c) Traceability established as per NABL policy		
	d) Availability of maintenance plan of equipment		
	e) Availability of equipment records.		
	Remarks:		

Sl.	Requirement	Observation (Mark ✓ in the appropriate box)	
		Yes	No
6.	Equipment calibration and metrological traceability		
	a) Whether biobank has specified the requirements for calibration and traceability		
	b) Whether procedures for calibration of equipment are available		
	c) Whether documented unbroken chain of calibrations is available for maintaining metrological traceability of its measurement results		
	Remarks:		
7.	Internal Quality Control (IQC) (when biobanking has opted for testing activity)		
	a) Availability of quality control procedures.		
	b) Availability of appropriate quality control materials		
	c) Availability of use of other methods for IQC if appropriate IQC material is not available		
	d) Availability of defined acceptability criteria to control reporting of invalid data		
	Remarks:		
8.	Internal Audit		
	a) Availability of Audit program		
	b) Availability of Audit Plan		
	c) All requirements of ISO 20387: 2018 as applicable, covering all activities of biobank audited at least once in the last one year		
	d) Timely corrective action on non-conformities		
	e) Audit conducted by competent and independent personnel		
	Remarks:		
9.	Quality Management reviews		
	a) Availability of Management review plan		
	b) All requirements of clause 8.9 of ISO 20387:2018, are incorporated in the agenda of review in the last one year		
	c) Availability of minutes of last Management review meeting		
	Remarks:		
10.	Discussions with the Biobank on Initial Assessment		
	a) Overview of the methodology to be adopted		
	i. About team and number of the assessors		
	ii. Procedure of Test(s) Witness		
	iii. Process for competency evaluation		
	iv. Assessment of collection centres, wherever applicable.		
	v. Number of audit days required		
	b) Obligations of the biobank (as per NABL 100A, 100B, 227, 131)		
	Remarks:		
Signature/ Name of the Lead Assessor			

* Mark ✓ in the appropriate box

NON-CONFORMITIES OBSERVED DURING PRE-ASSESSMENT

Biobank:		Date of Assessment:
Sl.	Non-conformity (to be filled by Lead Assessor)	Corrective Action proposed by the biobank (to be filled by biobank)
Signature/ Name of Authorised representative of Biobank & Date		Signature/ Name of Lead Assessor & Date

Note: Use additional sheets of this form, if required

PRE-ASSESSMENT REPORT

Biobank:			
Person responsible to implement management system:			Date of assessment:
Field: Biobanking	Category(s):	Activity:	
Applicable Standard: ISO 20387: 2018			
NABL Specific Criteria – NABL 229			
Contact person for NABL (Biobank's staff only)			
Corrective action taken on the document review report implemented:			Yes / No
Latest version of Quality Manual/ Management system document			
-ISSUE NO. & DATE			
-AMEND NO. & DATE			
Submission of NABL 131 (Terms & Conditions)			Submitted earlier/ Enclosed/ Not submitted
No. of Non-conformities during Pre-assessment			
Summary of Pre-Assessment:			
Recommendations of time estimation and readiness of biobank:			
▪ Number of Assessors required, category wise, as per scope of accreditation			
▪ Number of audit days required			
▪ Whether the assessment is required to be split based on locations of biobank or number of categories If yes, elaborate			Yes / No
▪ Is the Biobank ready for Assessment If no, specify estimated time for taking corrective actions (<i>Max 15 days</i>)			Yes / No
Any specific recommendations:			
Signature/ Name of Head of the Biobank & Date			Signature/ Name of Lead Assessor & Date

DECLARATION OF IMPARTIALITY & CONFIDENTIALITY

(to be filled in by each Assessor and enclosed with the Assessment report)

Name		Assessor ID: (To be filled in by NABL Sect.)
Designation		
Organisation		
Address		
Capacity	Lead Assessor / Technical Assessor / Technical Expert / Observer	
CAB* Assessed		
Date of Assessment		
Type of Assessment	<i>Document Review / Pre-Assessment / Initial assessment / Onsite Surveillance / Re-Assessment / Supplementary visit</i>	

*CAB – Conformity Assessment Body (Testing / Medical / Calibration laboratory / Proficiency Testing Provider (PTP) / Reference Material Producers (RMP), Biobank)

I _____, hereby declare I have no conflict of interest in any form with the CAB nor offered any consultancy, guidance, supervision or other services to the CAB (e.g. internal audit), in any way.

I am / am not* an ex-employee of the CAB and am/ am not* related to any person of the management of the CAB.

I got an opportunity to go through various documents like Quality Manual, Procedural Manuals, Work instructions, Internal reports etc. of the above CAB and other related information that might have been given by NABL. I undertake to maintain strict confidentiality of the information acquired in course of discharge of my responsibility and shall not disclose to any person other than that required by NABL.

*Strike out which is not applicable

Date:

Place:

Signature

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